CREDIT SUISSE

REFERENCE for

Mr. Pooya Pakzad, born May 19, 1981

Date of entry: January 1, 2021 Date of departure: March 31, 2023

Mr. Pooya Pakzad joined our company on the above date with the title of Assistant Vice President.

In his role as an Agile Coach in the Financial Institutions (FI) area within the Chief Technology and Operations Office, Mr. Pakzad was primarily responsible for the following tasks:

- Managing and leading the business IT systems for FI and External Asset Management (EAM) applications
- Assuming responsibility for the Service Level management and change initiatives of those applications and the delivery of initiatives within scope, budget, time and quality
- Leading the teams to deliver successful application releases and meet the go-live deadlines according to the agreed SLA and by managing and mitigating CISO risk and audit items
- Ensuring commitment to the goals by coaching the teams and directly intervening when needed and managing and/or helping to escalate impediments
- Promoting and supporting agile practices, metrics, and mindset across the teams and business units and enabling the teams to evolve and make the right decisions for the growth of the business
  - Supporting the leadership and cross-functional teams in team building, conflict resolution and building resilience; supporting product owner and scrum master communities of practice by solving problems
  - Coaching the teams to decentralize know-how and remove or reduce single points of failures leading to T-shaped cross-functional and self-organizing team structures and supporting the teams by identifying their competence and weaknesses and empowering them to step up in gaining and building knowledge

In addition to the above, Mr. Pakzad assumed the following responsibilities:

- Coaching and empowering teams and business stakeholders, ensuring steady improvement in adopting an agile culture and narrowing the deltas
- Conducting training sessions and workshops (e.g., strategy and vision workshops, retrospectives, conflict solving, root-cause analysis, ideation, planning, and alignment workshops)
- Successfully managing and triaging technical tasks and providing solutions to tackle technical debt within the scope of delivery by allocating timeboxed capacity while keeping the teams' velocities unimpacted

We are pleased to confirm that Mr. Pakzad was a conscientious, entrepreneurial and exceptionally proactive member of Middle Management who demonstrated an integrated way of thinking. Furthermore, he responded optimally to client needs and was viewed as a competent contact person. We would especially like to mention Mr. Pakzad's extensive know-how of Agile Leadership and his expertise in facilitating workshops, which enabled him to establish a team spirit and a culture of cooperation, collaboration and trust among the team members and business partners. He led by example, enforcing culture change and pursuing DevOps adoption within the value stream. Thanks to his pronounced organizational talent, Mr. Pakzad always met deadlines and completed his duties in an efficient manner. He produced very good results in terms of both quality and quantity at all times, thereby corresponding to our high requirements and expectations in every respect.

We came to appreciate Mr. Pakzad as a motivated and very dynamic employee who put forward remarkably constructive arguments and displayed above-average negotiating abilities. Furthermore, he addressed impediments actively and managed to achieve brilliant solutions. Mr. Pakzad was open for new ideas and regularly came up with innovative approaches. As a coach, he effectively motivated employees to achieve more and contributed significantly to the positive development of the team. Mr. Pakzad's helpful and particularly team-focused nature ensured that he was held in equally high regard by all who worked with him. His conduct toward clients, superiors and colleagues was impeccable at all times and exemplary in every respect.

Mr. Pakzad is leaving us as of March 31, 2023, of his own accord, and we regret his departure. We would like to thank him for his good contribution and wish him all the best and every success for the future.

CREDIT SUISSE (Switzerland) Ltd.

Christoph Gubser

Christoph Gubser
Head of Corporate Banking Products

Tobias Graffunder

Tobias Graffunder
Head of AS IT Fund Operations Systems

Zurich, March 31, 2023 / dg